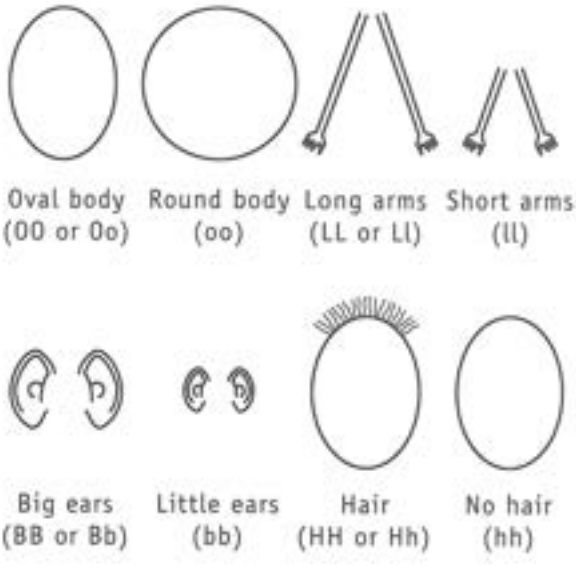
Genotypes and Phenotypes

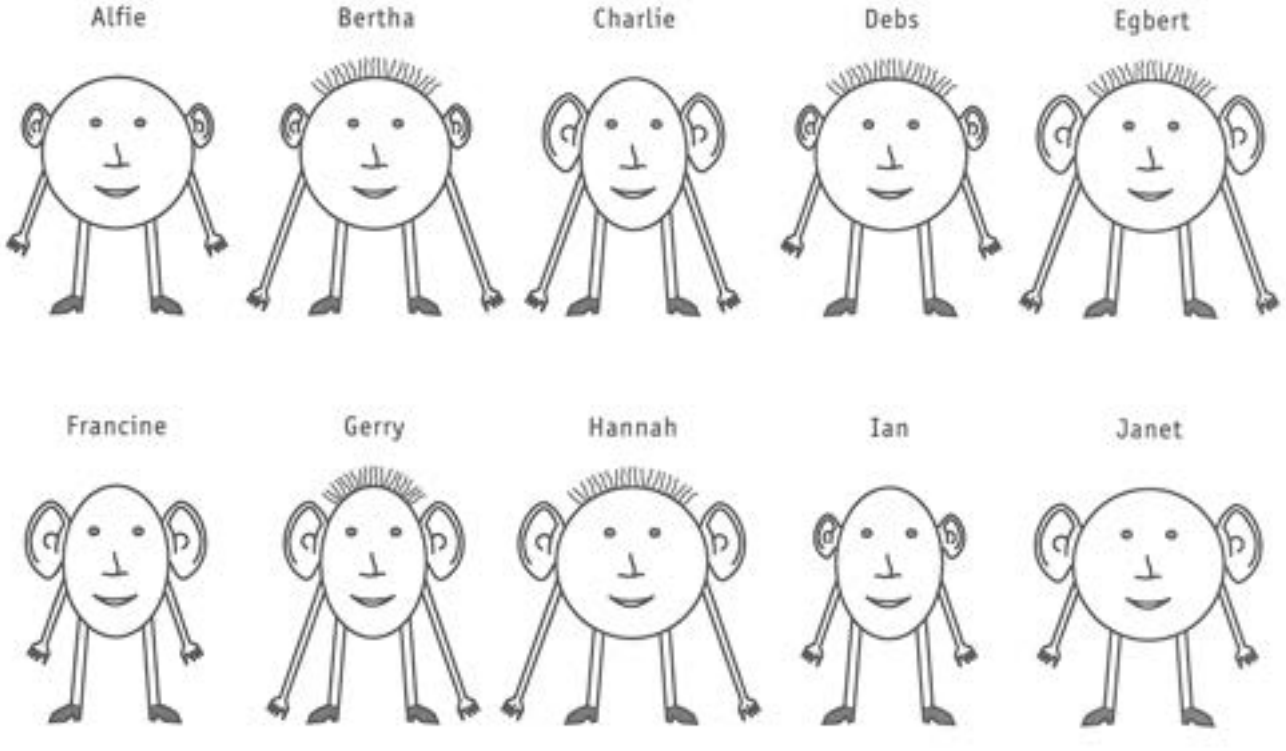
6

The Griblets are a race of beings who live on the planet Gribbo. They look strange, but their genetics follow the same pattern as those of humans on Earth. We are going to study four of their physical characteristics (phenotypes). These are shape of body, length of arms, size of ears and hair. The genotypes (genetic composition) and phenotypes are shown on the right.



1 What is meant when the genotypes are shown in upper case (for example H) or lower case (for example h) letters?

The pictures below show a 'family album' of a group of Griblets.



2 Draw up a table, showing the name, and the phenotypes and genotypes for body, arms, ears and hair for each Griblet.

3 Which Griblets have identical phenotypes?

4 Do the individuals mentioned in Question 3 have the same genotypes for the traits illustrated? Explain your answer.

5 What conditions would be needed for the seemingly identical Griblets to be identical twins?

6 Think of another physical characteristic of the Griblets that hasn't been mentioned. Describe two possibilities for this phenotype and your suggested genotypes for this characteristic.

© Peter Gribben, Wendy St Germain and Emerald City Books, 2001. This sheet may be photocopied for non-commercial classroom use.

© Blake Education 978 1 92561 060 4 Assignments in Genetics Book 1